

figure into a worksheet. Now in cell C2, type, without the quotes, “=B2*\$B\$8”, then hit [Enter]. Select cell C2 again and hover over the bottom right corner of the cell till the mouse pointer changes to a plus sign. Then click and drag downwards to cell C6.

In the above example, the US Dollar to Indian Rupee conversion rate is specified in cell B8. In the Indian Rupees column, there is an absolute reference to cell B8 and a relative reference to the US dollar values of the items in the US dollar price column. An absolute reference is denoted by using the “\$” symbol prefixed before the column reference and the row reference. In this example, the absolute reference to cell B8 is denoted by \$B\$8. Thus in column C, the reference to the cells in column B is *relative*, but the reference to the cell B8 is *absolute*.

You can also have a *partially absolute* reference, that is, the reference will be absolute for either column or row. Continuing with the above example, if you use \$B8, the reference will be absolute with reference to Column B but relative with reference to the row. Similarly, B\$8 will be absolute with reference to row 8 but relative with reference to column B. You can also switch between the reference types easily: highlight the reference type you want to change and press [F4] to cycle through relative, partially absolute, and fully absolute reference modes.

3.5 Referring to Another Workbook

Not only can you refer to another worksheet in the same workbook, you can also refer to cells and cell ranges in other workbooks. You can merge data from several workbooks into a single worksheet, use formulas to manipulate the data, and also use relative or absolute referencing that will change according to how you move the data in your worksheet.

References to other workbooks will be of the form
=SUM([Sales.xlsx]Annual!B23:B49)